History would be an excellent thing, if it were only true.

Leo Tolstoy, writing to N. N. Gusev, 1908.

The past is never dead. It’s not even past.

William Faulkner, *Requiem for a Nun*, 1951.
Paraphrased by Barack Obama in his presidential nomination speech ‘A more perfect union’, Philadelphia, 1 March 2008.